

Ben McKee

Game Design and Development Student



LinkedIn Profile – [Ben McKee](#)

Portfolio Website – [Ben McKee](#)



About Me

I am a highly motivated game designer and dedicated developer with a passion for gaming. I am currently studying Game Design & Development at Ulster University. During my time at university, I have learned a great deal about the games industry, including game development of both physical and virtual games. I aim to build on my knowledge of programming and development, with my goal to lead a successful game development team.



Skills

Technical Skills

- **Programming:** C# scripting, Unity, AI systems, UI development, game physics.
- **Video Editing:** OBS, DaVinci Resolve.

Soft Skills

- **Problem Solving:** Problem solving.
- **Teamwork:** Leadership, communication.

Design Skills

- **2D Art:** Aseprite/Libresprite, Pixel art, 2D animation, UI/UX Design, tile palettes, character design.
- **Level Design:** Tilemapping, world design.
- **3D Modelling:** Probuilder, 3D Greyboxing.

Audio Design Skills

- **Singing:** 8+ years of singing experience (including live performances).
- **Piano:** 10+ years of piano playing (including live performances).



Education

BSc (Hons) Games Design and Development

Ulster University (2025-2029)

Semester 1:

- Fundamentals of Game Programming – 88%
- Game Design Theory and Practice – 70%
- Game Graphics – 83%

OCR Level 3 Cambridge Technical Extended Diploma in Performing Arts

Northern Regional College (2018-2020)

- Distinction, Distinction, Merit (DDM)

9 GCSE's

Our Lady of Lourdes High School (2013-2018)

English Language (B)	Maths (B)
ICT (B)	French (B)
Geography (C)	Double-Award Science (BC)
COPE (Pass)	Moving Image Arts (B)



Interests

- **Gaming** – I enjoy playing video games as a hobby and as an inspiration for my own game design.
- **Programming** – I have a passion for programming video games, which keeps me up to date with developments in programming, expanding my knowledge and reinforcing what I already know.
- **Producing Music** – Music has been an influential part of my life and has proven useful in sound design within my own games.
- **Mixed Martial Arts** – I train in MMA multiple times a week. This keeps me focused, my mental health in check, and has taught me discipline, which I can transfer to all parts of my life.
- **Musical Theatre** – I have studied and performed in a multitude of shows within Musical Theatre. This includes a professional production titled “Paper Boy” at the Belfast Lyric Theatre and many other indie shows. Musical Theatre has taught me transferable skills such as teamwork, creativity, leadership, communication, performance and following directions.

Divinity

Role – Designed and created a board game, titled “Divinity”.

Key Systems – Custom counters and cards featuring original graphic designs. Also included a custom-illustrated board for the game.

Tools Used – Microsoft Word used for the Game Design Document; Krita used for original graphic designs.

Feedback – The overall feedback from play testers was positive and rated highly.

3D Level Design

Role – Designed and created 3D Models and created a fully original 3D level.

Key Systems –

- Textured environment, with an eerie atmosphere and suitable lighting.
- Worn-down buildings and rubble.
- Interactable and functioning doors.
- A dynamic sound system, with certain sounds changing depending on whether the player was indoors or outdoors.
- Zombie NPC with AI pathfinding, player tracking, range detection and attacks.

Tools Used – Probuilder to create 3D Models; Unity for programming, level design and level creation.

2D Game Demo

Role – Designed and developed a 2D Game Demo. All graphic designs were designed and created by me, including the animated sprites and tile maps.

Key Systems –

- Custom-engineered, wave-based enemy spawning system that was fully customisable from the Unity inspector.
- An interactable weapon wheel that slowed down time when displayed.
- Integrated spell system featuring a fireball projectile and continuous arcs of lightning.
- A UI timer that began after a trigger, counted down, and then ended the demo after 10 minutes.

Tools Used – Aseprite for animated sprites and tile palette; Unity for programming and tile mapping.

Feral

Feral is a 2D-Sidescrolling action-platformer game developed by a team of 4.

Role – Lead programmer, supporting team members with programming issues and optimisation, expressing original ideas, encouraging creativity and coordinating closely with the team as well as regularly consulting with them all using the Agile approach, the scrum framework, and the kanban workflow.

Key Systems –

- Attack combo system – customisable from the Unity inspector.
- Smooth movement system – customisable character top speed, acceleration, deceleration, minimum jump height, maximum jump height and jump force.
- Interactable NPCs with dialogue.
- Checkpoint system.
- Intelligent waves of varied enemies with player tracking, detection range, and spawn points.

Tools Used – Miro Board for brainstorming and level design, Microsoft Teams for team communication, Aseprite for animated sprites and tile palette and Unity for programming and level creation.

Certificates:

- Grade 8 in Musical Theatre from Trinity College London
- RSL Level 2 Certificate in Musical Theatre Performance Grade 5